

# Mujibnagar Govt and War Affairs

# Mujibnagar Govt Cabinet Structure

Office

President

Vice President (Acting President)

Prime Minister

Finance Minister

Commander-in-Chief of the Bangladesh Forces

Foreign Minister

Home Minister

Office Holder

Sheikh Mujibur Rahman

Syed Nazrul Islam

Tajuddin Ahmad

Mansur Ali

Colonel M. A. G. Osmani

Khondaker Mostaq Ahmad

Abul Hasnat Muhammad Kamaruzzaman

# Constituent Assembly

## **Parliament**

The interim constitution converted Bengali members of Pakistan's national and provincial assemblies elected in the 1970 general election into members of the [Constituent Assembly of Bangladesh](#).

## **Administration**

On 2 June, Bangladesh was divided into five administrative units, called Zonal Administrative Council, governed by elected legislators. On an order (GA/810/345) issued by the prime minister on 27 July the number of zonal councils was increased to 9 and their functions were formalized. On another order (GA/7366/500), issued on 18 September, the number was increased to eleven. The administrative zones were headquartered in Indian territories bordering the zones. The administrative zones were the following:

# Birth of Bangladesh Armed Forces

As the war broke out, East Bengal soldiers serving in various Pakistan Army battalions had revolted and raised an armed resistance against Pakistan forces all over East Bangla immediately. Rebel commanders of these battalions, mostly junior officers, unaware of the establishment of a provisional government, met along with Colonel Osmani on 4 April.

At that meeting, the Bangladesh Forces BDF, was formed, with Colonel Osmani as its Commander-in-Chief. A provisional command structure and operation plan was adopted until a government could be formed. Prime Minister Tajuddin learned of the Bangladesh Forces while he was in New Delhi. In his 10 April radio speech he uniformly granted it official recognition. Subsequently, Lt. Colonel M. A. Rab took over as the Chief of Staff of Land Forces (Army). During August 1971 Group Captain A K Khandker took over as his Deputy. After November 21, 1971, Khandkar was entitled as Deputy Chief of Staff of Army (Liaison)

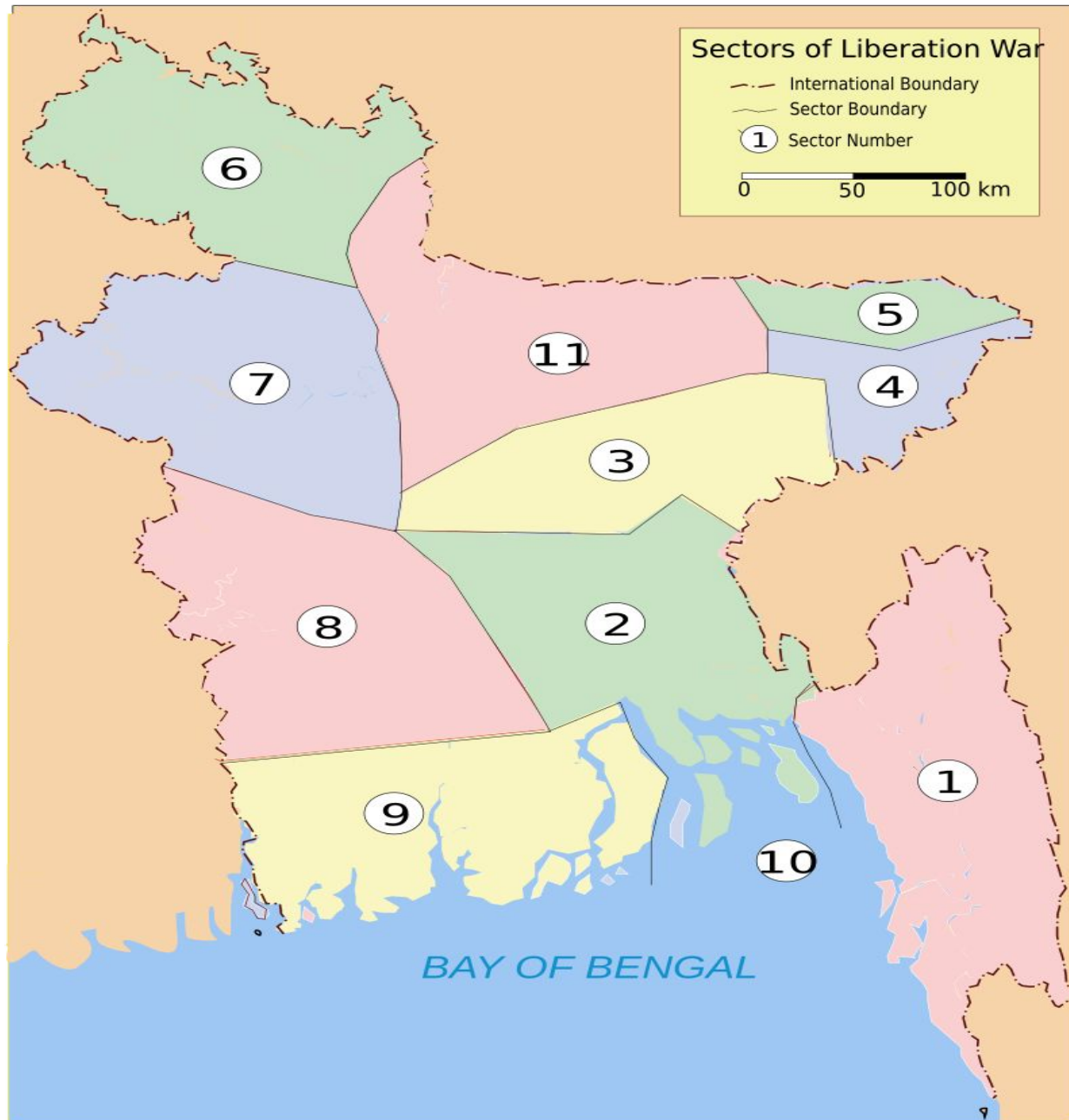
Commander-in-Chief of Bangladesh Forces (BDF): Colonel M A G Osmani

Principal Military Representative Provincial Government (Guerrilla Training) Squadron Leader: M. Hamidullah Khan, TJ, SH

- Chief of Staff( Army): Lieutenant Colonel M. A. Rab, Deputy Chief of Staff (Liaison) Group Captain: A K Khandker
- In July, Osmani amalgamated the 3 battalions under Ziaur Rahman's command into a brigade, called 'Z-force'. Similarly, in August–September, two more brigades, 'S-force' and 'K-force', and 3 more battalions for them (9, 10, and 11 EBRs) were partially raised.

# Sector Commanders

- Bangladesh was divided into eleven Military operational sectors. Each sector was charged with eleven military commanders mostly having the rank of army Major and equivalent. They include:
- 1) Major Ziaur Rahman, Captain Rafiqul Islam
- 2) Major Khaled Mosharraf, Major ATM Haider
- 3) Major K. M. Shafiullah, Captain A. N. M. Nuruzzaman
- 4) Major Chitta Ranjan Dutta, Captain A Rob
- 5) Major Mir Shawkat Ali
- 6) Wing Commander M Khademul Bashar
- 7) Major Nazmul Huq, Major Quazi Nooruzzaman, Subedar Major A Rab
- 8) Major Abu Osman Chowdhury, Major Abul Manzoor
- 9) Major M. A. Jalil, Major MA Manzur, Major Joynal Abedin
- 10) Lieutenant AM Ataul Haque
- 11) Major Ziaur Rahman June 10, 1971 – October 10, 1971, (Interim) Major Abu Taher (October 10, 1971 – November 2, 1971 (injured from minor grenade blast), Squadron Leader M. Hamidullah Khan (November 2, 1971 – April 6, 1972)



# Bureaucracy

Many Bengali members of the [Civil Service of Pakistan](#) defected to the government of Bangladesh. [Kamal Uddin Siddiqui](#), [Noorul Quader Khan](#), [S. A. Samad](#), [Khandaker Asaduzzaman](#), [Saadat Husain](#) and [Akbar Ali Khan](#) were early leaders of the newly formed [Bangladesh Civil Service](#). [Moudud Ahmed](#) served as [Postmaster General](#). The provisional government established an elaborate structure of administrative departments. [Yusuf Ali](#) and J. G. Bhowmik served as the chief Relief Commissioners for Bangladeshi refugees. The noted artist [Quamrul Hassan](#) served as Director of Art and Design. Kolkata and Agartala were the main centres of the government-in-exile.

# Diplomatic Affairs

| Name                                                | Title                         | Mission                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <a href="#"><u>Humayun Rashid Choudhury</u></a>     | Ambassador-at-Large           | New Delhi                       |
| <a href="#"><u>Abul Maal Abdul Muhith</u></a>       | Ambassador-at-Large           | Washington, D.C.                |
| <a href="#"><u>Rehman Sobhan</u></a>                | Special Envoy                 | Washington, D.C.                |
| Justice <a href="#"><u>Abu Sayeed Chowdhury</u></a> | Chief Overseas Representative | London                          |
| <a href="#"><u>Abul Fateh</u></a>                   | Ambassador-at-Large           | <a href="#"><u>Calcutta</u></a> |

# Resistance by Mukti Bahini

The Mujibnagar government coordinated the war efforts of the Mukti Bahini—a guerrilla resistance movement formed by Bengali military, paramilitary and civilians—and the nascent Bangladesh Armed Forces. ..

- Members of the [Mukti Bahini](#) launched a mass guerrilla war against the [Pakistani military](#), liberating numerous towns and cities in the war's initial months.
- At first, the Pakistan Army regained momentum during the [monsoon](#), but Bengali [guerrillas](#) counterattacked by carrying out widespread sabotage, including through [Operation Jackpot](#) against the [Pakistan Navy](#), while the nascent [Bangladesh Air Force](#) flew [sorties](#) against the Pakistani army.
- The Mujib Bahini, initially called the Bangladesh Liberation Force (BLF), was a politico-armed force formed during the Bangladesh Liberation War to fight against Pakistan in 1971. The force was mainly composed of activists drawn from the Awami League and its student front, the Chhatra League. At its height, it had reportedly 10,000 members.
- Using guerrilla warfare tactics, the Mukti Bahini secured control over large parts of the Bengali countryside. It conducted successful "ambush and sabotage" campaigns, and included the nascent Bangladesh Air Force and the Bangladesh Navy.



# India joins war

- India joined the war on 3 December 1971 in support of the Mukti Bahini, after Pakistan launched [preemptive air strikes](#) on northern India.
- The Pakistan Air Force (PAF) launched a preemptive strike on Indian Air Force bases on 3 December 1971. The attack was intended to neutralize the Indian Air Force planes on the ground. India saw the strike as an open act of unprovoked aggression, which marked the official start of the Indo-Pakistani War.
- The war began with Pakistan's Operation Chengiz Khan, consisting of preemptive aerial strikes on eight Indian air stations. The strikes led to India declaring war on Pakistan, marking their entry into the war for East Pakistan's independence, on the side of Bengali nationalist forces.
- The subsequent [Indo-Pakistani War](#) involved fighting on two fronts; with [air supremacy](#) achieved in the eastern theater and the rapid advance of the [Allied Forces of Mukti Bahini and the Indian military](#).